

Tarrytown: Austin's Most Established Neighborhood — A Complete Buyer's Guide

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THE SHORT ANSWER

Tarrytown sits west of downtown Austin, within Austin ISD's Casis Elementary zone — the most sought-after elementary assignment in AISD. Home prices range from \$1.2M to \$4M+. Limited inventory, very low turnover, and a 10-15 minute downtown commute make it one of the strongest long-term holds in the Austin market.

Tarrytown occupies a specific place in Austin's residential hierarchy that has nothing to do with hype and everything to do with scarcity.

It is one of the few genuinely established neighborhoods in Austin's urban core — a place where the streets feel mature, the lots are generous, and the oak canopy has had decades to grow into something irreplaceable. It is also one of the most consistently sought-after addresses in the city, for reasons that hold across interest rate environments, tech cycles, and broader market fluctuations.

Where Tarrytown Is and How It Feels

Tarrytown is bounded roughly by Mopac (Loop 1) to the east, Lake Austin Boulevard and the lake to the west, 35th Street to the north, and the Windsor Road corridor to the south. The neighborhood's character is defined by its tree canopy — some of the largest, most established live oak trees of any urban Austin neighborhood. This canopy creates shade, dampens sound, and gives blocks a sense of enclosure and maturity that new construction communities in outer Austin simply cannot replicate.

Casis Elementary: The Single Most Consequential Factor in Tarrytown Pricing

Most of Tarrytown falls within the Casis Elementary attendance zone — and Casis Elementary is, by most measures, the most sought-after elementary school assignment within Austin ISD. It consistently earns high ratings from state and independent sources, and feeds into O. Henry Middle School and Austin High School. The Casis premium is measurable and documented: homes within the Casis zone trade at a consistent premium over comparable homes one or two blocks outside the zone.

Buyers should always verify the specific school assignment at the exact property address using the AISD school finder and a direct call to the district.

What Homes in Tarrytown Actually Look Like

Tarrytown's housing stock runs from original 1930s and 1940s bungalows to extensively renovated historic homes to new construction on teardown lots. Original bungalows in need of work can enter the market below \$1,200,000. Renovated or updated homes of 2,500 to 4,000 square feet range from \$1,400,000 to \$2,500,000. Significantly rebuilt or newly constructed homes on premium lots — particularly those with lake views on the western edge — regularly reach \$3,000,000 to \$5,000,000.

Lot sizes commonly run 7,500 to 12,000 square feet for interior lots, with some estate lots reaching a quarter acre or more.

The Teardown Question

Tarrytown has seen significant teardown activity over the past decade. Austin's tree protection ordinances affect what can be built on Tarrytown lots — protected heritage oaks cannot be removed without a permit and mitigation process. For buyers planning significant renovations or new construction, understanding which trees on a property have protected status is part of pre-purchase due diligence.

Commute and Walkability

Downtown Austin is typically 10 to 15 minutes from most Tarrytown addresses at peak hours. The neighborhood has limited walkability to grocery and retail — Jefferson Square on Exposition Boulevard offers a few shops, but the nearest full grocery requires a short drive. The adjacency to Lake Austin's shoreline on the neighborhood's western edge is a genuine lifestyle asset not replicated in any other central Austin neighborhood at comparable distance from downtown.

Who Buys in Tarrytown

The most common buyer profile is a family with school-age children for whom the Casis elementary zone is the primary motivator. These buyers are typically comparing Tarrytown to Westlake Hills: Tarrytown means a shorter downtown commute and more urban residential character; Westlake means Eanes ISD and a more suburban environment. A second buyer profile is the established Austinite making a significant move-up purchase — often trading up from a smaller 78704 or Clarksville home.

Resale Strength and Long-Term Value

Tarrytown's resale profile is among the strongest in the Austin market, driven by proximity to downtown, the Casis Elementary zone, and the irreplaceable lot and tree canopy character. These factors held value through multiple Austin market cycles. During the 2022 to 2024 period of broader Austin price correction, Tarrytown experienced less price softening than outer-ring and suburban communities. Inventory is persistently low — annual turnover is among the lowest of any desirable Austin area.

Foundation Considerations

Tarrytown's older housing stock means pier-and-beam foundations are common in original homes built before 1960. These are repairable and well-understood in Austin but require specific inspection attention. Buyers from newer-construction backgrounds should understand that pier-and-beam is a characteristic of older construction, not necessarily a concern — a qualified inspector who understands central Austin's older housing stock can assess accurately.

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

What is Tarrytown known for in Austin?

Tarrytown is known as one of Austin's most established and desirable central neighborhoods — characterized by a mature live oak canopy, generous lot sizes, proximity to downtown Austin (10-15 minutes), and location within Austin ISD's Casis Elementary attendance zone, the most sought-after elementary school assignment in AISD.

How much do homes cost in Tarrytown, Austin?

Tarrytown home prices in 2026 range from approximately \$1,200,000 for entry-level properties needing updating to \$2,500,000 for mid-range renovated homes of 2,500 to 4,000 square feet. Architecturally significant new builds and estate lots on the western edge near Lake Austin commonly reach \$3,000,000 to \$5,000,000.

What school district is Tarrytown in?

Tarrytown is within Austin ISD. Most of the neighborhood falls within the Casis Elementary attendance zone — the most sought-after elementary assignment in AISD. Casis feeds into O. Henry Middle School and Austin High School. Always verify the exact assignment using the AISD school finder before making an offer.

How far is Tarrytown from downtown Austin?

Tarrytown is approximately 2 to 4 miles from downtown Austin, with peak-hour commutes of 10 to 15 minutes via Enfield Road, Lamar, or Mopac depending on specific address.

Is Tarrytown a good investment in Austin real estate?

Yes. The combination of Casis Elementary zoning, mature tree canopy, proximity to downtown, and persistently low inventory has maintained price floors through multiple Austin market cycles. The neighborhood experienced less price softening than outer-ring communities during Austin's 2022-2024 correction.